LEADERSHIP, CONFLICT AND FAILURE: THE BEHAVIOURAL QUESTIONS THAT CHALLENGED AN MBA APPLICANT

CASE STUDY STRATEGY WORKSHEET: NISHA MALHOTRA | MBA INTERVIEW PREPARATION

1. Student Persona & Challenge Diagnostic Audit

Candidate: Nisha Malhotra | Profile: HR professional, 6 years of experience.. This worksheet outlines the systematic forensic diagnostic and strategic intervention designed to resolve this admissions roadblock.

Assessment Dimension	Diagnostic Finding & Initial Challenge	Strategic Objective
Candidate Profile	HR professional, 6 years of experience.	Build differentiated application proposition
Core Admissions Roadblock	Nisha was comfortable discussing her professional responsibilities but struggled to explain difficult situations. Questions about workplace ...	Eliminate systemic bottlenecks through data feedback
Root Cause Identified	Misalignment between effort and strategic execution	Shift from generic repetition to targeted intervention
Admissions Target	Competitive Global / Indian MBA Program	Maximize admit ROI and scholarship potential

Key Diagnostic Insight:

"A high test score or strong resume alone is not a substitute for a coherent admissions story. Every applicant requires a personalized roadmap that aligns quantitative readiness with distinctive leadership impact." — Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee)

2. Step-by-Step Strategic Intervention

- Identified relevant behavioural competencies.
- Mapped real workplace experiences to those competencies.
- Used structured storytelling frameworks such as STAR.
- Practised leadership and conflict scenarios.
- Used AI-based simulations to explore follow-up questions.

3. Actionable Checklist for MBA Applicants

- Diagnostic First: Never increase preparation hours or rewrite essays without an objective diagnostic baseline.
- Data-Driven Tracking: Use targeted analytics to monitor error patterns rather than counting raw study hours.
- Holistic Narrative: Connect undergraduate background, career progression, and MBA goals into one cohesive arc.
- Expert Perspective: Involve senior mentors early to eliminate blind spots and stress-test interview responses.
- Advice: A preparation strategy must fit your reality. Consistency always beats sporadic marathons.

Need help communicating your leadership experiences? Start with an MBA interview assessment.

Schedule a 1-on-1 strategy session with Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee) at www.mbawizards.co.in